

# Free-range roasted seitan with mushroom ragout

This is essentially the same recipe as the Light Meat Seitan (page 232), with slight modifications for a **roasted** dish. While good any time, this dish, topped with a savory mushroom ragout, may be especially appropriate around the holidays if you are looking for a vegetarian substitute for turkey or chicken. Serve with rice or mashed potatoes.

Vegetable oil

Uncooked prepared dough from Basic Seitan Recipe (page 230)

## BRAISING LIQUID

1 tablespoon nutritional yeast

2 teaspoons unrefined cane sugar

1 teaspoon mustard powder

1 teaspoon dried thyme

1 teaspoon onion powder

½ teaspoon crushed hot red pepper

½ teaspoon celery seed

½ teaspoon fennel seeds

½ teaspoon dried rosemary

½ teaspoon dried sage

3 garlic cloves, minced

½ teaspoon salt

½ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

¼ cup dry white wine [60ml]

2 tablespoons olive oil

2 teaspoons soy sauce

2 teaspoons white wine vinegar or lemon juice

## GLAZE

¼ cup dry white wine [60ml]

2 tablespoons olive oil

2 teaspoons soy sauce

2 teaspoons lemon juice

1 teaspoon unrefined cane sugar

Mushroom Ragout (recipe follows)

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F [190°C]. Liberally oil a 4½ by 8½ inches [11 by 22cm] loaf pan and set aside. **Prepare** the Basic Seitan Recipe dough through Step 1.
2. Combine all the braising liquid ingredients in a large bowl and **mix** well. Do the same for the glaze in smaller bowl or measuring cup and set aside.

3. Add the prepared dough to the liquid. **Knead** together for about 2 minutes, until the ingredients are very well incorporated. Put the seasoned seitan and any remaining liquid in the loaf pan and press the dough down as much as possible. If the dough separates from itself after kneading, fold the edges under. At this point, the dough will not fill the pan; it will expand during cooking. (The loaf can be made ahead to this point up to 24 hours in advance. Cover tightly with plastic wrap and refrigerate.)
4. Cover the pan with aluminum foil and **bake** for about 2 hours. During the first hour, baste twice with the pan juices. After that time, use the glaze to baste a couple more times. Uncover for the last 5 minutes of cooking. The finished roast should be firm but still springy to the touch. Remove to a cutting board, let rest 5 minutes, then cut into ½-inch [1-cm] slices with a sharp serrated knife. Add the seitan slices to the hot Mushroom Ragout and simmer for 2 minutes before serving.

SERVES 4 TO 6

## Mushroom Ragout

2 tablespoons olive oil

1 medium onion, thinly sliced

½ pound combination of various fresh mushrooms (chanterelle, cremini, portobello), thinly sliced [250g]

6 dried shiitake or porcini mushrooms, soaked in 1 cup [250ml] hot water, drained, water reserved

2 garlic cloves, crushed through a press

1 tablespoon unbleached all-purpose flour

2 teaspoons minced fresh thyme

1 tablespoon tomato paste

1 teaspoon red miso

1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

1 tablespoon balsamic vinegar

1. In a large skillet, **heat** the olive oil over medium-high heat. Add the onion and cook, stirring occasionally, until golden, about 5 minutes. Add the fresh and dried mushrooms and the garlic and cook, stirring often, until the mushrooms soften and give up their juices, 5 to 7 minutes longer.
2. **Sprinkle** the flour and thyme over the mushrooms. Cook, stirring, about 1 minute. Pour in the reserved mushroom soaking liquid and bring to a boil, stirring until the liquid is smooth and thickened. Stir in the tomato paste, miso, salt, and pepper. Reduce the heat to low and simmer for 3 minutes. Stir in the vinegar.